

What landed since Friday morning

Window: Fri 26 Sep 2026 08:00 Brussels (06:00 UTC) → Mon 28 Sep 07:50 Brussels · main at 22797083 · Repos: spec-kitty, spec-kitty-planning

A reliability weekend that ended with product decisions. Most of what shipped stops the CLI from quietly damaging a user's work. Overnight, the pending calls all landed: the doctrine audit fixes, the merge → consolidate rename, and hosted publishing becoming opt-in. The open P0 list shrank from 22 on Sunday afternoon to 18, and most of what remains is red nightly suites.

47 pull requests merged (46 engine, 1 planning)	126 issues closed (101 fixed, 20 not planned, 5 duplicate)	16 P0 issues closed	169 new issues opened	18 P0 issues still open
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The bottom line

- SHIPPED

User work is safer. Eight P0 data-loss bugs were fixed. Examples: upgrades deleting customised templates, charter fetch wiping pack clones, encoding repair turning "José Peña" into garbage, and merges or implement runs leaving committed work unreachable while reporting success.
- SHIPPED

Two customer-visible changes are on main for 4.0.0rc5. `spec-kitty merge` is now `spec-kitty consolidate`; the old name prints a migration message and stops. Hosted publishing to Team Kitty is off by default and needs an explicit opt-in from both the repository and the developer.
- SHIPPED

The doctrine we ship is cleaner. In-house guidance no longer ships to customers, and shipped instructions now name commands that exist and say "Mission" instead of "feature". This closed four P0s from Sunday's audit.
- SHIPPED

The review loop works as designed. Reviewer feedback now reaches the implementing agent, and a merge refuses to land a mission whose review verdicts are unfinished.
- WATCH

18 P0s open, and CI is still catching up. Six are red nightly or integration suites, including a new one from the test folders CI started running on Saturday. The fix for the accept step trusting a stale acceptance check is open as [#5249](#).

What shipped, by theme

1. Protecting user work

8 PRs · 9 P0s closed

Customers trust the CLI with their repositories. These fixes close cases where it destroyed or hid work and still exited cleanly.

- **P0** Upgrades no longer delete a customised spec template, and charter fetch no longer wipes or hard-resets an existing pack clone. [#5050](#)
- **P0** Charter and spec encoding repair now picks the right code page, keeps a backup, and refuses to overwrite one. [#5170](#)
- **P0** Implementing a work package whose lane branch was deleted now stops instead of silently starting over from an older point. [#5035](#)
- **P0** A repair command run in a shallow or CI clone no longer flattens a live team mission and hides everyone's approvals. [#5137](#)
- **P0** Resuming an interrupted merge now recovers the checkout safely, and squash merges no longer ship a canceled work package's file deletions. [#5031](#) [#5054](#) [#5040](#)
- Analysis runs no longer demand a clean checkout or put unrelated work at risk (external contribution by samuelgoff). [#5017](#)
- **P0** The accept step silently skipping its whole acceptance check was closed as fixed on Sunday. [#4891](#)

2. Changes customers will notice

4 PRs · 4 P0s closed

These ship with the next release candidate. Both CLI changes need a line in the release notes.

- **P0 Breaking:** lane consolidation is renamed from `merge` to `consolidate`, so the command name no longer suggests a publish to origin. Scripts and CI steps calling `spec-kitty merge` must switch. [#5224](#)
- Hosted publishing is opt-in and no hosted endpoint ships by default. Machines that were already logged in keep their endpoint. [#5174](#)
- **P0** Core-team guidance moved out of the built-in pack, so customers stop receiving our in-house rules. [#5223](#)
- **P0** Shipped doctrine now names real CLI commands, uses the correct documentation-mission mode, and says "Mission" instead of "feature" in about 100 places. [#5217](#)

3. Mission workflow reliability

11 PRs · 1 P0 closed

The spec → implement → review → consolidate loop had friction that made agents and operators work around the tool.

- Reviewer feedback on a rejection now reaches the implementer's next prompt, including when the project sits inside another git checkout. [#5177](#) [#5242](#)
- **P0** Mission review reads verdicts from the right place on team missions, and a mission with unfinished verdicts can no longer land. [#5222](#)
- Lane branch names now come from one source, so merges stop disagreeing about which branch belongs to a lane. [#5166](#)
- The default squash merge no longer wrongly refuses clean missions, and the merge target's tip is read one consistent way. [#5055](#) [#5124](#) [#5039](#)
- Starting several CLI commands at once on a fresh machine no longer crashes, and template lookup is thread-safe. [#5123](#) [#4995](#)
- Fixes for friction the team hit while running missions on this repo, plus a merge-code cleanup. [#5173](#) [#5245](#)

4. CI and quality gates

14 PRs

Green CI only helps if it covers the code. This work removed places where main looked healthy but wasn't being checked, which is also why new reds are appearing.

- A green main or nightly now means the tests actually ran, and test folders no CI job reported on run every night (they were hiding 13 failures). [#5042](#) [#5216](#)
- Architecture gates that passed without checking anything were fixed or retired, and their scanners now fail loudly on files they can't read. [#5164](#) [#5167](#) [#5141](#)
- Three red-main incidents cleared, and CI runners pinned to Ubuntu 24.04 ahead of GitHub's default switch. [#5127](#) [#5121](#) [#5247](#) [#5066](#)
- Windows-only crashes removed from gate tests, and the events-package contract pinned at 10.4.0. [#5057](#) [#5195](#)
- A test-timing check that forced an 18-minute re-capture on many PRs no longer blocks merges (interim fix), and a stale review test was repaired. [#5240](#) [#5190](#) [#5161](#)

5. Governance and architecture

8 engine PRs · 1 planning PR

The rules agents follow, and the shared picture of how the system fits together.

- Three pack-trust decision records were amended and accepted, and the tracker's label taxonomy was extended. [#5241](#)
- The decision record for sharing agent commands through charter packs is merged with status Proposed; accepting it is still open. [#5192](#)
- Specs now label each acceptance criterion by how it is proven, and reviewers must check that a criterion can actually fail. [#5133](#)
- Agents are told not to skip canonical commands on an assumption about prompt size, and in-house missions no longer run the full heavy test suites locally. [#5165](#) [#5176](#)
- A review of 70 past missions' friction logs and an engine alignment review against the shared architecture were published. [#5102](#) [#5191](#) [#5136](#)
- The Kitty Shared Architecture is now a browsable docsite in the planning repo. [planning](#) [#2655](#)

Backlog decisions

Beyond the fixes, the backlog changed shape. These closures reflect scope choices rather than shipped code.

OUTCOME	ITEMS	WHAT IT MEANS
Not planned	#2790 + 3 children	Signed run-record attestation is off the roadmap for now.
Not planned	#1193	The 3.3.0 planning-workspace and epic-decomposition epic is dropped.
Not planned	#5036 #3279	A P0 about review-cycle commits and a P1 device-login 401 report were closed without a fix.
Epics complete	#2173 #2160 #3493 +4	Infrastructure separation, team-mission status authority, operator configurability and four others are now done.

The planning repo's automated fleet last reported at 05:19 UTC Sunday, consistent with the agent fleet being switched off on purpose. A standing notice there about the programme's decision authority (dated 27 Aug) was also closed.

What's next and needs a decision

169 issues were opened in the window. Most group into new programmes of work; a few items need a call.

ITEM	STATUS	DECISION OWNER
Release 4.0.0rc5 with the consolidate rename and hosted opt-in; both need release notes #5224 #5174	ON MAIN, UNTAGGED	Release owners
Accept fails closed on a stale or failing acceptance matrix, fixing a PO #5249	PR OPEN	Stijn (merge)
Split the Python 3.13 nightly leg into six shards, aimed at the red nightly POs #5244	PR OPEN	Stijn (merge)
Accept the pack-skills decision record, now merged as Proposed #5192	AWAITING CALL	Stijn
New programmes: glossary packs (7 steps), one owner per doctrine rule, shorter agent instructions, acceptance-matrix integrity, org-pack lifecycle, orchestrator API contract	FILED	Prioritisation

Who shipped it: Stijn authored 40 of the 46 engine PRs; Jeroen (MOES-Media) authored 5 plus the planning docsite; samuelgoff contributed 1.

Method: merged PRs and closed issues were read from GitHub for both repositories, filtered on merge or close time at or after 06:00 UTC on 26 Sep, as of 05:50 UTC on 28 Sep. "Closed as fixed" follows GitHub's close reason; where no linked PR is visible (for example #4891), that is stated as closed rather than verified fixed.